User Manual



Welcome to JatayuOS

Udaan Aapki. Shakti Bharat Ki.

Made in India - an independent desktop project created by Anup Yadav, built with Debian 13 and KDE Plasma.

Version 0.1 Release Candidate | AMD64 | Guide edition: 1 October 2026

This candidate is prepared for testing before the final release. A successful ISO build does not replace live-session, installation and hardware tests.

Start here

Boot the ISO and open Aarambh. Choose **Try JatayuOS** to explore the desktop or **Install JatayuOS** to open the installer. The manual and FAQ are available offline from Aarambh, the application menu and the live desktop.

Before installing	Back up your data and verify the ISO checksum. First test the candidate in a disposable virtual machine.
Guide map	2 Installation | 3 Desktop and applications | 4 Jatayu apps | 5 Language and Android | 6 Help | 7 Credits and legal notices

Install and first start

1. Verify the download

Keep the ISO and SHA256SUMS together. On Linux, run **sha256sum -c SHA256SUMS**. On Windows PowerShell, use **Get-FileHash -Algorithm SHA256 path-to-iso** and compare the complete hash. A matching checksum confirms the downloaded bytes match the supplied file.

2. Prepare a test environment

Use an AMD64 virtual machine or a supported 64-bit PC. The installer checks for at least 25 GB storage and 1.5 GiB RAM. Those are installer thresholds, not a performance guarantee. Allocate additional space and memory for office work, updates and Android.

3. Boot the live session

Attach the ISO to the VM, or write it to a USB device using a trusted image-writing tool. Writing an image replaces the USB contents. Start from the selected device, then wait for the boot menu, Plymouth and KDE desktop. Secure Boot compatibility has not been certified for this candidate.

4. Review the installer

Open Install JatayuOS. Confirm your keyboard, time zone, account and target disk. India / Asia-Kolkata is the initial time-zone choice. Read the partition summary carefully: erase-disk installation deletes data on the chosen disk. The desktop welcome screen has no language selector.

5. Restart into the installed system

After the installer completes, restart and remove the installation medium when requested. Aarambh opens on the installed desktop. Connect to your network, open Discover and review updates.

Offline installation

The build includes desktop packages and both BIOS and UEFI GRUB platform binaries for an offline installation path. Online services, new software, updates and Android image setup require internet. Offline installation still needs testing on this exact candidate.

Your desktop and daily applications

The Jatayu menu opens installed applications. The bottom panel provides pinned apps, running windows, network and sound controls, the clock and a desktop switch. Firefox ESR remains Mozilla-branded.

Dolphin	Browse Home, Desktop, Documents, Downloads, Pictures, Music and Videos. Open Places from the side-panel controls if hidden. Your own bookmarks remain editable.
Firefox ESR	Web browsing using the Debian Firefox ESR package. External links from Jatayu web apps open in your default browser.
LibreOffice	Writer for documents, Calc for spreadsheets, Impress for presentations, plus Draw and the other packaged suite components.
Discover / Settings	Discover manages software and updates. System Settings controls displays, audio, network, appearance, shortcuts and regional options.
Files and media	Kate edits text; Konsole provides a terminal; Ark handles archives; Gwenview views images; Okular reads documents; Spectacle captures screenshots.
Storage and diagnostics	Partition Manager and GParted manage storage; htop and fastfetch show system information. Partition changes can destroy data.
Desktop services	NetworkManager, PipeWire, Bluetooth, Fcitx5 and firmware packages support common hardware; actual compatibility depends on the device.

Useful keyboard shortcuts

Meta: application menu. Meta+E: Dolphin. Alt+Space: KRunner. Alt+Tab: switch windows. Ctrl+Alt+T: terminal when the KDE default binding is enabled. Custom bindings can be changed in System Settings.

Dock and files

Right-click an application to manage its panel pin. New accounts receive standard user folders before Aarambh opens; Dolphin supplies its native Places model. Mounted drives appear when detected. Existing bookmarks and user preferences are not reset.

Jatayu applications

Open the Jatayu Tools menu for the bundled utility suite. Each application has a specific purpose; online services retain their own terms and privacy policies.

Aarambh	Welcome and first-start hub: offline help, Files, Firefox, Discover, Settings, Editing Tools, Wallpaper Changer and About. Clear the startup checkbox to stop automatic opening.
Jatayu Editing Tools	The supplied 2.0.2 desktop utility for image/PDF processing. Choose input files, operation and a new output path. Keep originals and check exported results.
Jatayu Wallpaper Changer	Version 1.2.1: 24 offline India, nature and space scenes, search, favourites and automatic rotation. Choose a screen or all screens; the app applies wallpapers through Plasma.
Kavach	Local dashboard with links to firewall settings, system updates and personal-file backup. Its dashboard does not certify system security.
Sarkar Setu	A local directory of public-service links. External sites open in Firefox; their operators handle accounts and transactions.
Utsav	The owner-supplied local HTML application, opened in its own desktop window. Its content is bundled unchanged.
Sanjeevani / Jaanch	The shared Jatayu app contains personal-folder backup and basic local diagnostics. These are not full-system snapshots or boot recovery.
Bhasa Setu / Android Setup	Shared-app entry points for language/input settings and Waydroid readiness. Standard KDE settings and official Android setup remain authoritative.

Wallpaper collection

The bundled PNG exports are 1920 x 1080, resized from generated masters. The scenes are AI-generated artwork, not verified photographs of the depicted locations. Application licensing and artwork notices are separate. Your wallpaper settings are stored in your own account.

Personal-file backup

Use Kavach's backup action or **jatayu backup**. Choose a source folder and a separate destination, preferably on an external disk. Restore to a new directory; verify important files before deleting any originals.

Language, input and Android

Indian languages and keyboard input

Open System Settings for display language, regional formats and keyboard layouts. These are separate choices. Open Fcitx5 Configuration to add an input method such as a Hindi method supplied by m17n. Sign out and back in when required.

The Wayland configuration lets KWin start Fcitx5 through its input-method socket. The independent XDG autostart is limited to an X11 fallback. If typing fails, review Virtual Keyboard settings in KDE and confirm the selected input method rather than starting several Fcitx processes.

Waydroid is included; Android setup is separate

Waydroid needs a compatible Wayland session, Linux binder support and working graphics. Download and initialise the Android system/vendor images using the official guide. Android images, Google apps, Play Store and ARM translation libraries are not bundled.

Typical initial setup, after reviewing the official guide: open a terminal and run **sudo waydroid init**; then start a user session with **waydroid session start** and open **waydroid show-full-ui**. Use administrator authentication for setup. Network access and additional disk space are required.

Official Waydroid installation guide
Official command-line reference

Android troubleshooting

If the UI does not start, check **echo $XDG_SESSION_TYPE** and **waydroid status**. An X11 session, missing binder devices or unsupported VM graphics can prevent operation. Android support varies by hardware and app; a VM may not provide suitable graphics.

Updates

Review Debian package updates in Discover. A separate signed Jatayu update repository has not been published. New ISO builds do not automatically update installed machines.

Help and candidate testing

Only Home in Dolphin	Open the Places panel. Confirm standard folders exist. Open the desired folder and add it to Places if needed. This build creates standard directories before Aarambh; user bookmarks stay under your control.
Installer does not open	Installation is available from the live ISO. Use the branded Install JatayuOS entry. If it fails, capture the error and the Calamares log; do not start another partition operation.
Wallpaper does not apply	Confirm that KDE Plasma is running. Check the selected screen and show the app error details. Automatic rotation needs the account's background service and a live Plasma D-Bus session.
Fcitx startup warning	Allow the desktop to settle, then inspect your input-method configuration. This build preserves diagnostics and extends the startup grace period; that is not proof of correct input on every machine.
Boot or display failure	Record BIOS/UEFI mode, VM configuration or hardware model and the exact stage reached. Test a graphics-safe boot option if provided by the boot menu.
Network or audio failure	Check the panel and System Settings. Record the adapter and driver information; do not assume a firmware package covers every device.

Report a problem

Contact **jatayuos4u@gmail.com** or use the project repository. Include the candidate ISO checksum, hardware/VM details, boot mode, exact steps, expected result and relevant logs. Review logs and screenshots for personal information before sharing.

Before the final release

Test live BIOS and UEFI boot; offline installation; first installed boot; network/audio; Dolphin Places; every dock pin; the wallpaper gallery and rotation; LibreOffice; input methods; and Waydroid on compatible hardware. A successful build precheck verifies source/package inputs, not all these behaviours.

Project source repository - access may be restricted while the candidate is under review.

Identity, credits and legal notices

Why JatayuOS?

Jatayu is the courageous bird associated with the Ramayana. The project uses the name to express courage, service and protection, and to connect its desktop identity with Indian culture. This is the project's naming story; it does not imply religious, governmental or institutional endorsement.

Made in India describes the project's origin and distribution work. JatayuOS is built on contributions from global open-source communities; it does not claim that every bundled component was developed in India.

Creator and maintainer: Anup Yadav. Thanks to Debian contributors, the Linux kernel community, KDE, Mozilla, Qt/PySide/PyQt, The Document Foundation, Calamares, Fcitx, Waydroid and the maintainers of all installed utilities, fonts, drivers and firmware. Exact package names and versions are recorded in the image's package manifest.

Installed copyright and licence files are retained under **/usr/share/doc**. Collected notices and the build package/source-version manifest are available under **/usr/share/jatayu**. Wallpaper application source is bundled under **/usr/share/doc/jatayu-wallpaper**.

JatayuOS is independent and is not affiliated with or endorsed by the Government of India, Debian, KDE, Mozilla or other upstream projects. Third-party names and marks remain those of their respective owners. Bundled components retain their individual licences. The project's original integration/artwork publication licence remains a maintainer decision; this guide grants no new licence.

Public redistribution requires review of applicable licences, trademarks, firmware/artwork rights and corresponding-source delivery. This candidate's notice collection and generic upstream links alone do not supply all required corresponding source.

Debian - source and distribution obligations

Debian - trademark policy

KDE - project and contributors

KDE - licensing

Mozilla - software distribution policy

Mozilla - trademark guidelines

LibreOffice - licences

Qt - licensing

Calamares - project and contributors

Waydroid - official setup guide

GNU GPL version 3